

Sharp again. *The resets.*

You know these techniques. Repetition sands the edges off. This is the tune-up.

FIDELITY DRIFT, AND THE RESET

WHAT SLIPS	DRIFTS INTO	THE RESET
Modeling	Quizzing — "what's this?"	Model to show, not to test
Wait time	Filled in two or three seconds	Count a silent ten
Prompting	Cues creep heavier	Lightest that works, first
Language	"Use your words" returns	Model plus a pause
Fading	Same support for weeks	Plan the fade, then follow it

The quiz is seductive. It gives you a response, and a response feels like progress. But a prompted correct is not a spontaneous correct. If your session is all quizzing, your data measures your prompt, not the student's language.

MODELING, THREE RESETS

- 1 One or two key words. Not every word
- 2 Model to show, not to quiz
- 3 Retire "use your words." Model, then pause

WAIT TIME

Ten to fifteen seconds of expectant silence. You give three. Three lets the student watch you answer for them. Count it, and let it feel too long.

Cues creep. Light cue fails once, you go heavier, heavier becomes baseline. Start at the lightest that has worked, not the heaviest that guarantees a response. No hand-over-hand on devices. Support the arm, never the message.

When the session *falls apart*.

Behavior is communication. Treat the message as data, not as the session being ruined.

THREE MOVES WHEN IT CLIMBS

Stop talking. Three words or fewer — during escalation they cannot take words in. **Model, do not demand. Honor the message, every time, in any form.** If the student communicates "break," the break happens. That is the session working, not failing.

The escape answer. Honoring the break request does not add escape — the student already escapes by screaming. You change the route. Fade the duration later. Never fade the reliability.

The SLPA boundary. You follow a behavior plan. You do not write or change it. Run the communication piece with fidelity, and flag what you see to your supervising SLP.

DATA YOUR SLP CAN USE

Measure the student, not the prompt. Prompted and independent are different columns. Blur them and the whole treatment plan drifts. Mark prompted data as prompted.

Know what to flag up. Exit criteria met, a goal that no longer fits, weeks of non-communicative use, a plan that isn't working. You don't fix these — you flag them, with data. You are the eyes in the room your SLP is not always in.



The VOICE check, five seconds. Visible, on, in reach, charged, every setting. None of the fidelity above matters if the device is dead in a backpack.